ThemeBot — the bumps in the road, and how we got past them

Challenges & fixes · 24 September 2026

> **The headline:** ThemeBot has now created a brand-new Shopify store on its own, connected to it, passed a live test edit and started building the theme from the ECO ELI website. No card, no manual steps. Getting there meant clearing several real obstacles. This report shows each one: what went wrong, what we did, and where it stands now.

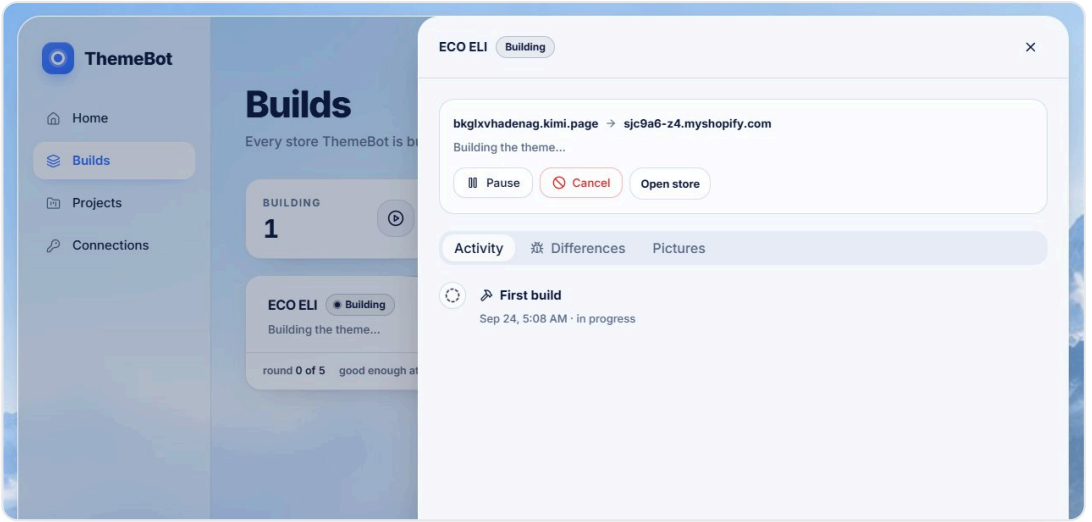
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obstacles hit	solved (5 fully proven, 1 fix in place)	to create a new Shopify store automatically	build to re-run so we can finish the ECO ELI theme

Every picture in this report is a real screen from the app or from Shopify, captured while the work was happening.

★ Where we are now: the automatic setup works

PROVEN ON ECO ELI

- ✓ **Sign in to Shopify once**
  In ThemeBot's own browser window. After that it remembers.
- ✓ **Brand-new store created in about 10 seconds**
  The payment screen is skipped automatically. ThemeBot never enters card details.
- ✓ **Connection to the store set up**
  ThemeBot creates its own secure connection and saves the keys, encrypted.
- ✓ **Live test edit passed**
  Proof that ThemeBot is really allowed to change the store's theme.
- ✓ **Store named properly**
  "ECO ELI", not Shopify's default "My Store".
- ✓ **Theme build started**
  ThemeBot wrote 100+ theme files: header, footer, pages, sections.
- ↻ **Build to be re-run**
  It was stopped early by an over-cautious timer (see obstacle 5). That is fixed; the next run picks up where it left off.



The ECO ELI store being built inside ThemeBot.

1 The AI assistant was blocked by a safety check

SOLVED

WHAT WENT WRONG

The first version used an AI assistant to click through Shopify and fetch the store's secret connection keys. A built-in safety check saw an AI handling secret keys and stopped it before it did anything. Nothing was created and nothing was harmed, but the setup could not go ahead.

WHAT WE DID

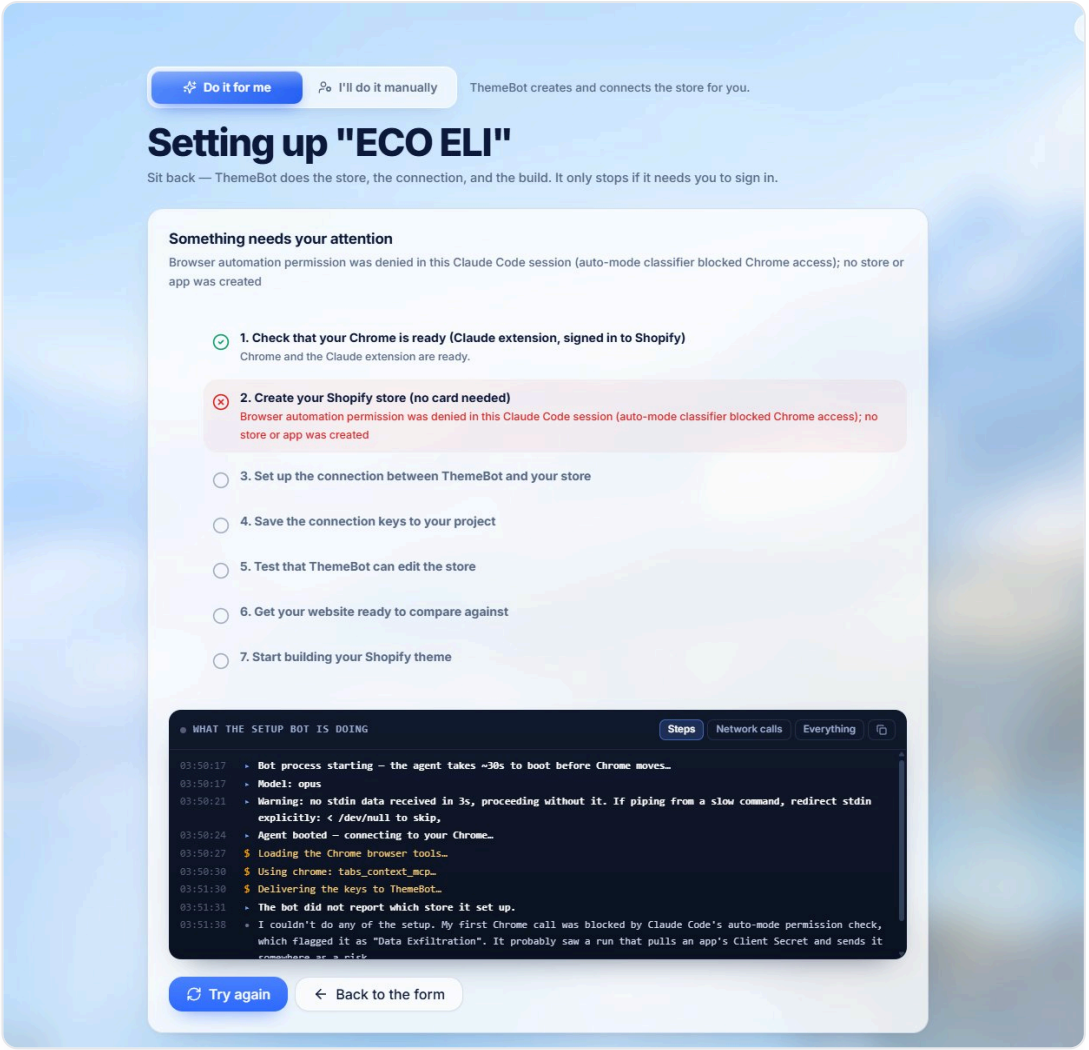
We switched to a **fixed, step-by-step script** for the Shopify part. It does the same clicks every time, with no AI involved. That means it's:

- much faster: seconds instead of minutes;
- free to run: no AI usage cost;
- safer: no AI ever sees the secret keys.

The AI version stays available as a backup button.

RESULT

The script set up the ECO ELI store and its connection end to end.



BEFORE The setup stopped at step 2 because the AI assistant was blocked.

2 Google refused to sign in inside the automated window

SOLVED

WHAT WENT WRONG

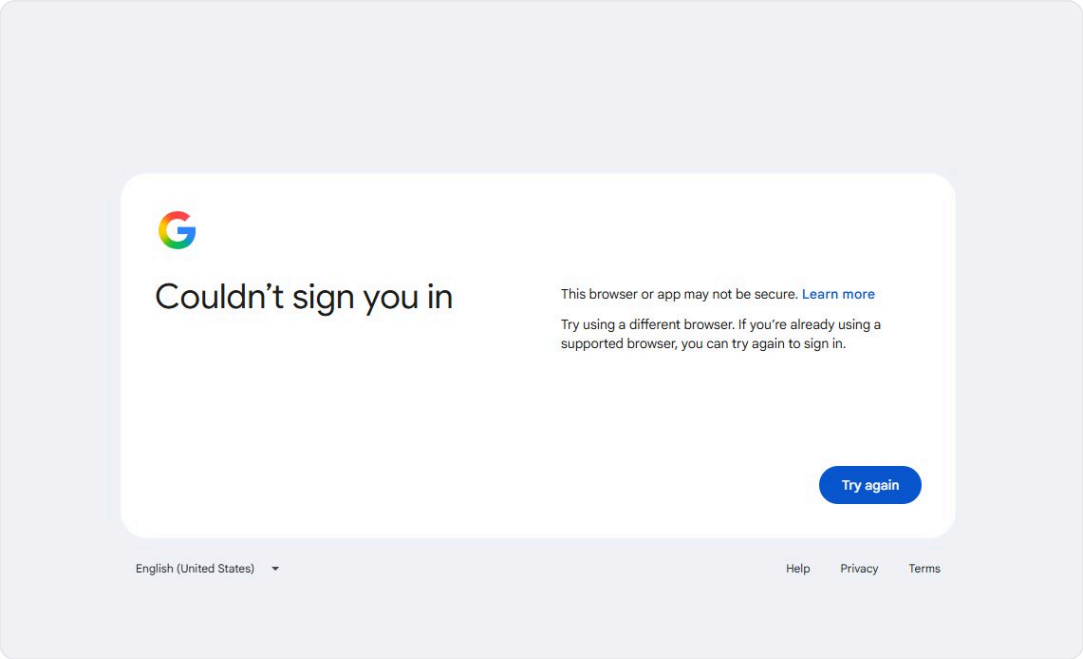
Google does not allow signing in inside a browser window that a program is controlling. It shows "This browser or app may not be secure", even for the account owner.

WHAT WE DID

The one-time sign-in now happens in a **normal browser window** that ThemeBot opens but does not control. You sign in the usual way (Google works), close the window, and ThemeBot reuses that saved sign-in. Your everyday Chrome stays open the whole time.

RESULT

Signed in once, and every run since has gone straight through.



BEFORE Google's refusal inside the automated window.

3 Shopify had quietly changed its own pages

SOLVED

WHAT WENT WRONG

Shopify had renamed and moved things since the script was first written. "Create store" is now "Create new store". The "Create app" button works differently. The store-name setting moved to its own page. The script was looking for the old versions and stopped.

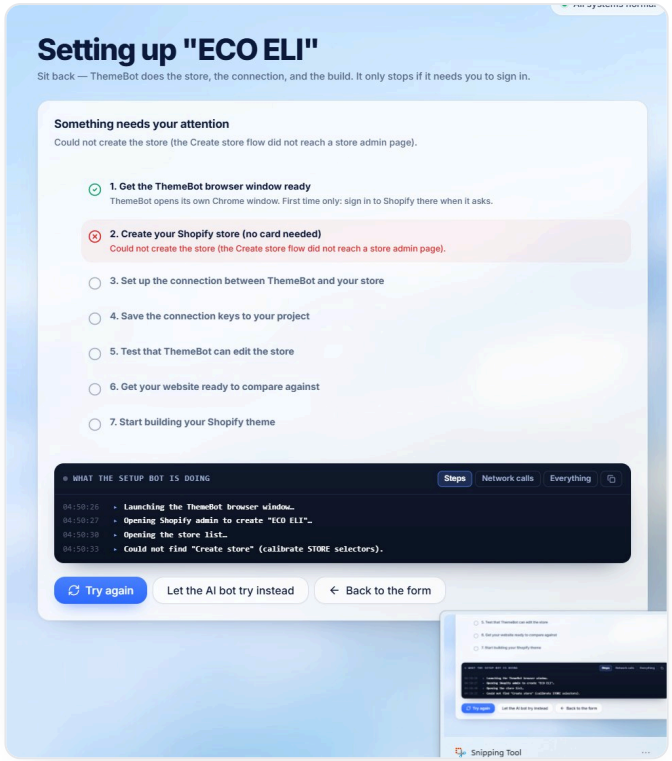
WHAT WE DID

We walked through Shopify's real pages together, one screen at a time, and updated the script to match. It now:

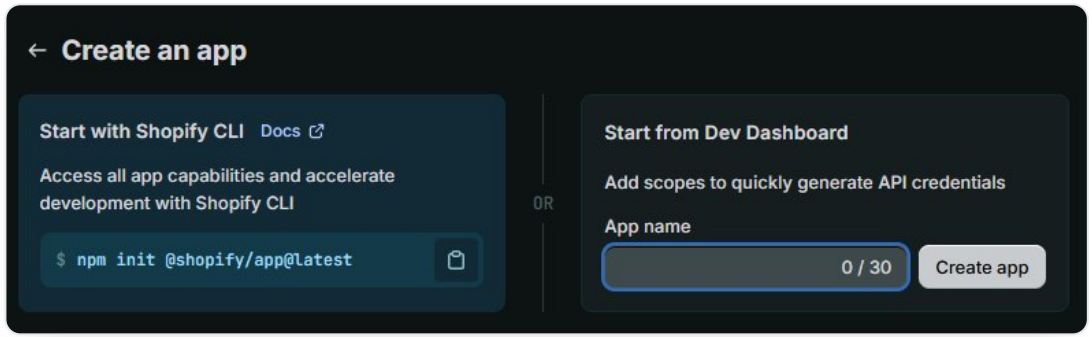
- goes straight to the right page instead of clicking through menus;
- recognises the different wordings Shopify uses;
- never touches any other store on the account.

RESULT

Store created in about 10 seconds, and the connection app created and installed on the first try after the update.



BEFORE "Could not find Create store": Shopify had renamed the button.



Shopify's current "Create an app" page, which the script now handles.

4 The new store kept Shopify's default name, "My Store"

SOLVED

WHAT WENT WRONG

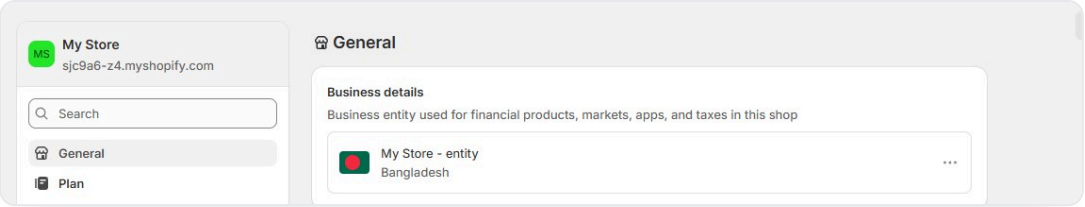
Shopify names every new store "My Store". ThemeBot tried to rename it, but the setting had moved (see obstacle 3), so the new store kept the default name.

WHAT WE DID

We found the store-name page, pointed ThemeBot straight at it, and renamed the ECO ELI store.

RESULT

The store is now called **ECO ELI**. Every future store gets its proper name automatically.



BEFORE The new store still showed "My Store". It has since been renamed to ECO ELI.

5 A long build was stopped as "stuck" while it was actually working

FIX IN PLACE, CONFIRMING ON NEXT RUN

WHAT WENT WRONG

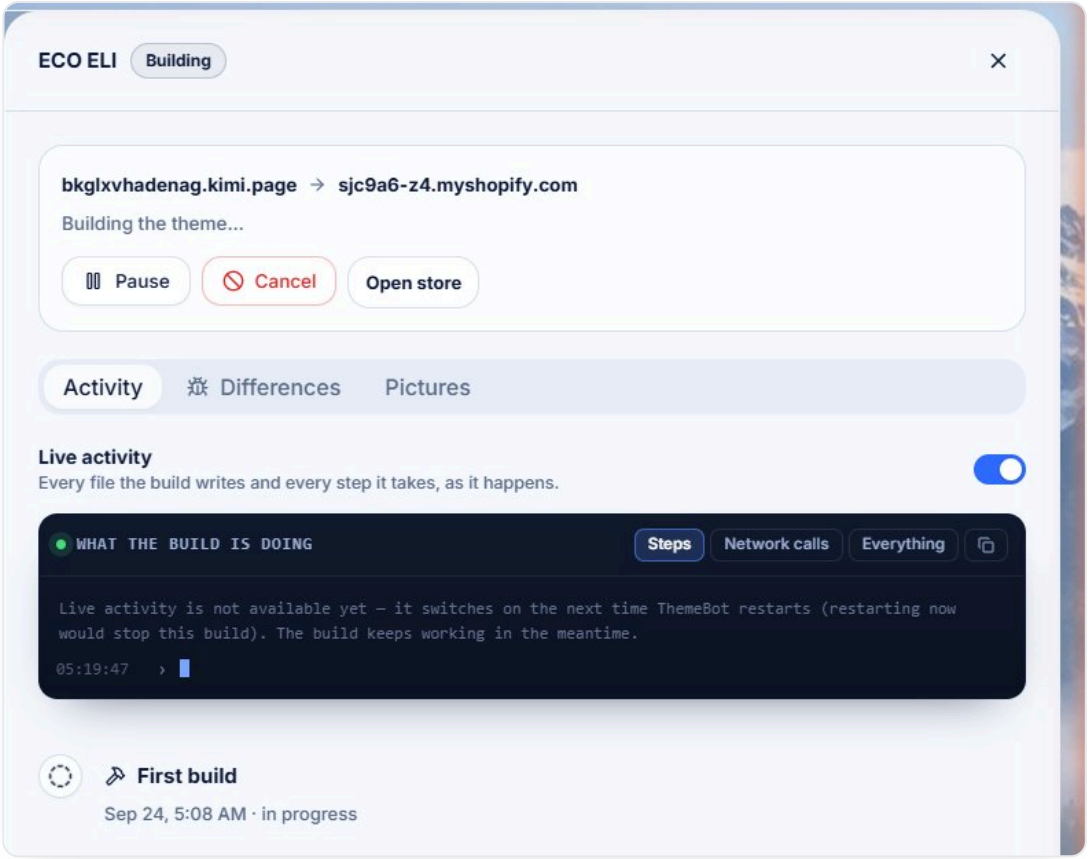
ThemeBot has a safety timer that stops a build if it shows no sign of life for 20 minutes. The build works quietly and only reported progress at the very end, so after 20 minutes the timer stopped it, even though it had already written over 100 theme files.

WHAT WE DID

- Builds now **report every step as they go**, so the timer can see they are alive.
- A new **Live activity** panel, with an on/off switch, shows exactly what the build is doing: every file it writes and every step it takes.

RESULT

The fix is in place. The ECO ELI build will be re-run to finish, and it continues from the files already written.

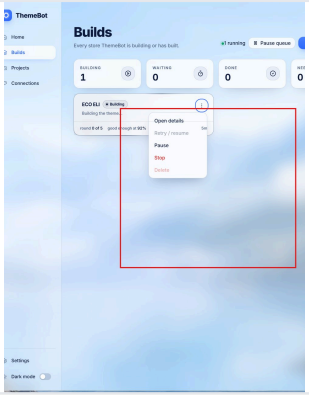


The new Live activity switch in the build panel.

6 Look and feel problems found in review

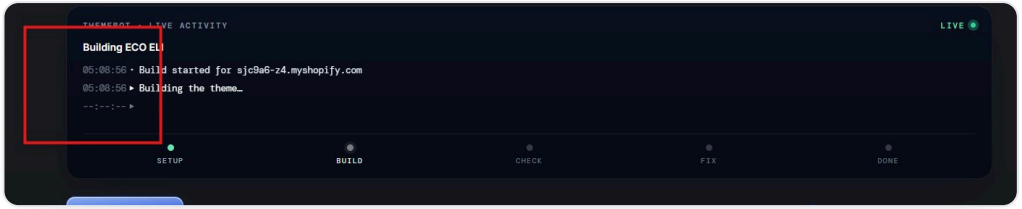
ALL FIXED

BEFORE



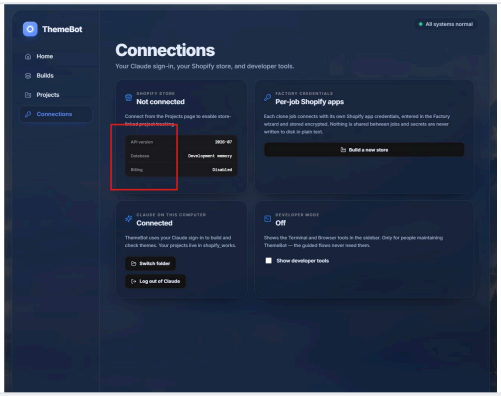
The card's menu let the text behind it show through. Now it is solid and on top.

BEFORE



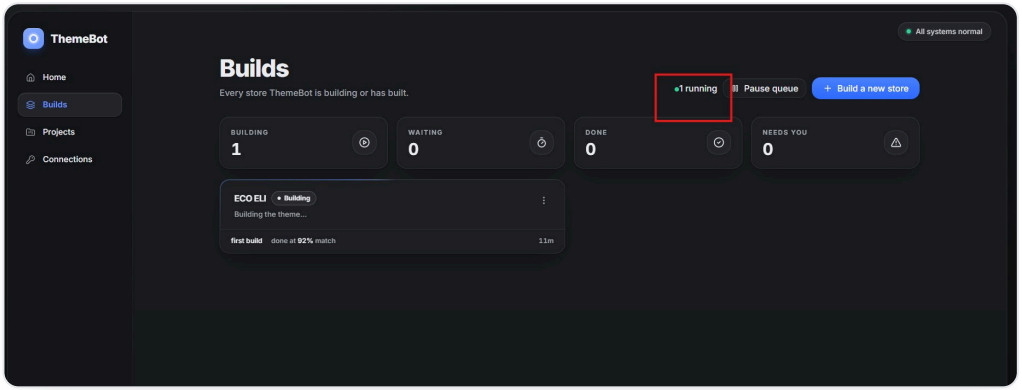
The activity text was too faint to read. Now it has clear contrast.

BEFORE



Dark mode was a see-through navy with unreadable boxes and black buttons.

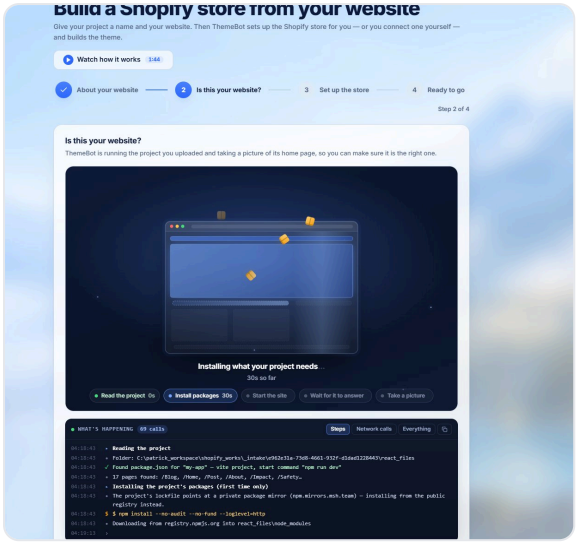
AFTER



Dark mode is now a solid, calm graphite with clear cards and buttons.

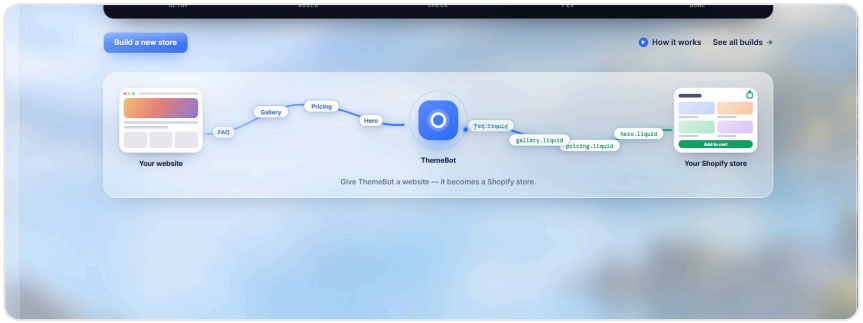
Improvements added along the way

NEW



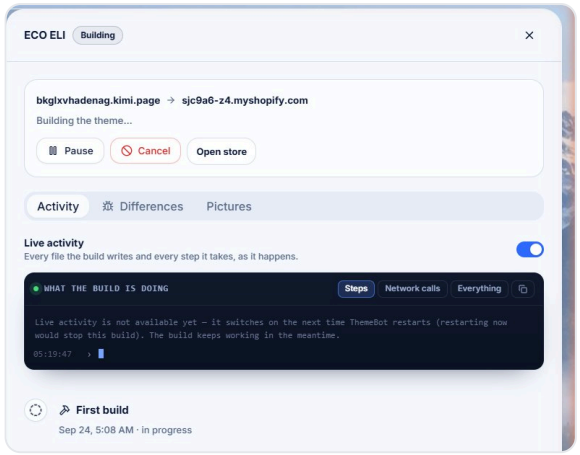
A clear "working" screen

While ThemeBot checks the website, an animation shows the page being assembled, each stage and how long it took. There's an optional mini-game for slow steps.



A friendlier Home screen

Shows at a glance how a website becomes a Shopify store. Small lights move along the lines while a build runs.



Live activity, on or off

Watch a build work in real time, with every file and every step, or switch it off.

→ What happens next

PLAN

ITEM	STATUS	NOTES
Re-run the ECO ELI build to completion	Next	Continues from the 100+ files already written, now with live progress.
"Time remaining" estimate during builds	In progress	Based on real progress: sections built versus sections planned. ECO ELI plans 15 pages and 118 sections.
Remove spare test stores created while fixing the setup	Next	Housekeeping on the Shopify account. The ECO ELI store stays.
Automatic store setup (sign-in, store, connection, test)	Done	Proven end to end on ECO ELI.
Look and feel fixes and new screens	Done	Menus, dark mode, readability, Home illustration, working screen, mini-game.

Bottom line: the hardest part, getting a brand-new Shopify store set up and connected without anyone touching it, now works. What remains is finishing the first full theme build and adding the finishing touches.